



SOUTH AFRICA REMAINS THE ONLY MAJOR TEST-PLAYING NATION WHERE INDIA HAS YET TO WIN A TEST SERIES

continues. It remains the only major Test-playing nation where India has yet to win a Test series.

Rohit Sharma's men have an excellent opportunity to set that record straight. The two-match series begins on December 26 in Centurion. The second Test will be played in Cape Town from January 3.

Back in 2006-07, under Rahul Dravid, now on his second tour of the country as coach, India got off to a perfect start in a three-match series, winning the first Test in Johannesburg by 123 runs, thanks largely to a superb show from

seamer S. Sreesanth (five for 40 and three for 59). It, however, lost both the remaining Tests of the series.

History repeated itself 15 years later, when Dravid went to South Africa as the coach for the first time. In the 2021-22 series, held without spectators due to COVID-19 concerns, the visiting team won the initial Test in Centurion — its

first-ever at the venue — by 113 runs. However, it faced defeats in the subsequent two matches in Johannesburg and Cape Town, both by a margin of seven wickets each.

Two years later, both teams have different captains. The Cape Town Test was the last for Virat Kohli as the Indian skipper. He stepped down a day after the match. Temba Bavuma